Chadwick (Chad) Kraus

Technical Support & Escalation Engineer | AI Automation & Support Operations | APIs, Identity & Networking
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Escalation engineer with 5 years of Tier 2/3 work across SaaS, networks, identity, and networked devices, and more recently, AI automation built around that work. At Rockbot, own a queue of **about 600 tickets and escalations a month**, act as the main link between Support and Engineering/QA, and have been technical owner on **about 15 customer pilots**. Built KPI dashboards that replaced **5–10 hours of manual reporting a week** and the AI support agent prototype that led to an AI voice agent now saving **about $20K a year**. Outside work, build full-stack and AI projects with Claude Code and Codex, from an incident-response simulator to a 62-mission networking game.

SKILLS

Escalation & Troubleshooting: Tier 2/3 escalation ownership · root cause analysis · log analysis · REST API & SaaS diagnostics · Postman · bug lifecycle management · postmortems · escalation playbooks

Networking & Identity: TCP/IP · DNS · DHCP · VPN · VLANs · firewall troubleshooting · PoE · Wireshark · connectivity diagnostics · SSO · SAML · OAuth 2.0 · MFA · Okta · Microsoft Entra ID

AI & Automation: Claude Code · Codex · MCP servers · n8n · AI voice agent training (Forethought) · Zendesk AI co-pilot · prompt engineering · human-in-the-loop review

Support Operations: Zendesk (admin) · KPI dashboards · knowledge base architecture · SOPs & onboarding · pilots & deployments · Jira · Salesforce · Tableau

Development: JavaScript/TypeScript · Node.js/Express · React/Next.js · Python (FastAPI) · PostgreSQL/Supabase · SQL · REST APIs · webhooks · Docker · Git · Playwright · Vitest

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Rockbot | Austin, TX (Remote)
Sep 2022 – Present

SaaS media and digital signage platform for multi-location businesses. Promoted to Network IT Specialist in April 2026 while continuing to own Tier 2/3 escalations.

Network IT Specialist
Apr 2026 – Present

- Own Tier 2/3 escalations, **about 600 tickets and escalations a month**, across customer networks and firewalls, SSO/SAML and Entra ID, REST APIs, and AV hardware.
- Act as the main link between Support and Engineering/QA. File most customer-impacting bugs and follow each one through prioritization, customer updates, and postmortem. Co-chair the weekly Bug Triage meeting, which surfaces **about 10 bugs a month**; the fixes have cut related ticket volume by **about 15%**.
- Built **Nightline**, an after-hours AI support agent prototype, which led Rockbot to bring in **Forethought's AI voice agent** (trial ongoing). Trained that agent and built its persona for after-hours and overflow calls. It now handles **about 20% of overflow calls** that used to go to an outside answering service, saving **about $20K a year**.
- Built Support and Escalation **KPI dashboards** with Claude Code and Zendesk's MCP server, which replaced **5–10 hours of manual reporting a week**. Leadership and the Support team use them to plan staffing, routing, and coaching.
- Found **2,000+ devices** running end-of-life firmware or legacy hardware, sized it as an estimated **$750K hardware revenue opportunity**, and built the business case and outreach program to replace units before they fail.
- Technical owner for **about 15 pilot and trial deployments** across SMB, Enterprise, and SLA customers, from deployment readiness and install calls through post-launch postmortems.
- Built a **Chrome extension** for **10 frontline agents** that pulls configuration and diagnostic data from smart amps, flags warnings, and explains device health in plain English. Ship updates with release notes and track adoption with built-in usage tracking and feedback.
- Lead a rebuild of **about 200 customer-facing articles** around a single internal source of truth, and build out Zendesk AI co-pilot features for agent assist, self-service, and support data cleanup.
- Noticed devices were logging SD-card errors that no one acted on, and built a daily triage from that data. It separates real failures from ejections, confirms replacement eligibility, and contacts customers before they report a problem (**about 50 devices a month**).

Technical Support Specialist Mar 2025 – Apr 2026
Customer Support Specialist Sep 2022 – Mar 2025

- Caught firmware defects mid-deployment on two major rollouts: a **30-location enterprise account** and a **43-location credit union**. On the credit union install call, traced smart amps that couldn't detect speakers to outdated Rev B firmware, then worked live with Engineering to deploy the fix to every incoming device and to Production. That kept the rollout on schedule and protected **about $12.9K in ARR**.
- Wrote the escalation playbooks and deployment documentation the Support team works from, and built the escalation onboarding program used to train **5 new team members**.
- Wrote weekly Bug Triage notes and monthly reports on Support-identified bugs for leadership and four cross-functional teams, so critical bugs got attention before they drove up ticket volume.
- Diagnosed escalations across the full AV and networked device lineup (media players, smart amps, Sonos, Amazon Signage Stick, Samsung Tizen), from network issues and AV signal flow to device firmware.
- Ran product test cycles and verified defects with Engineering as part of QA Ops. Mentored technical specialists and explained technical issues in plain terms for non-technical teams.

8am (formerly AffiniPay) | Austin, TX
Apr 2021 – Jan 2022

Technical Support Specialist

- Provided escalation support for a payments SaaS platform, troubleshooting API integrations, payment workflows, and transaction errors across web, network, and integration layers.
- Guided clients through PCI compliance, secure usage, and fraud mitigation while maintaining **99%+ CSAT**.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Ten applications built with Claude Code and Codex. Full portfolio: chad-kraus-portfolio.vercel.app

TechOps Command Center: Incident-Response Simulator | Next.js · TypeScript · Recharts · Vitest · Playwright
Simulates outages across a 15-service infrastructure. Charts, logs, the dependency map, and customer complaints all come from one model, so failures propagate the way they do in production. 8 scenarios, deterministic replay, 251 automated tests.

Switchboard: AI Support-Ticket Triage Agent | Next.js · TypeScript · Claude API · Vitest · Playwright
Drafts replies to support tickets that cite only the help-center articles it retrieved, and recommends resolve, needs info, or escalate. The model proposes and a deterministic rules engine decides, so security issues, data loss, and multi-customer outages always escalate. On 30 held-out tickets, run once, it caught all 13 escalations with no false escalations.

Packet & Pine: Cozy Networking Adventure Game | TypeScript · Three.js · Vite · Playwright · Vercel
Browser game that turns real networking and infrastructure concepts into a **62-mission** campaign, with illustrated and 3D gameplay and guided lessons. Missions follow the same loop as real troubleshooting: observe, form a hypothesis, make a safe change, verify, and roll back. Built with Codex, with local-first saves, responsive accessibility, security hardening, and comprehensive automated testing.

Jarvis: Permission-Gated Personal AI Assistant | FastAPI · Docker Compose · Chroma · Claude API · Tailscale
Runs entirely on home infrastructure with on-device wake-word detection. Connectors are deny-by-default and destructive actions require human confirmation. A security audit during the build found and closed an OAuth CSRF gap.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Google IT Support Professional Certificate (Google / Coursera) Oct 2023
Full-Stack Web Development Certificate, University of Texas at Austin Aug 2023